



Homeschool Credit Compass

The affordable college track, and transcripts colleges trust.

Scan the code (or type the address) for the full guide, links, and downloadable sample documents.



homeschoolcreditcompass.com

THE COLLEGE TRACK

- **Modern States (modernstates.org)**
Free online CLEP prep courses taught by professors, plus a voucher that covers the exam fee. Finishing a course also makes a solid high school credit on the transcript.
- **CLEP exams: \$97, or \$0 with a voucher**
One exam can equal one college course (3 to 6 credits). No minimum age, so capable middle and high schoolers can start early. Failing scores are never reported. Verify each exam with the destination college first: acceptance and minimum scores vary, and some cap how many credits by exam they take.
- **Dual enrollment**
Real college courses in high school, online or on campus, counting for both high school and college credit. Faith Baptist Bible College: \$150/credit (ask about the \$99 fall special). Cedarville, Bob Jones, Colorado Christian, and GCU (\$52.50/credit) also offer online options.
- **Iowa Last-Dollar Scholarship [Iowa only]**
Covers remaining tuition for eligible high-demand programs at Iowa community colleges (healthcare, IT, trades, welding, early childhood, and more). FAFSA required; the eligible-program list changes yearly. Some programs are fully online.
- **Christian Leaders Institute**
Free ministry and general-studies courses; low-cost degrees through Christian Leaders College (about \$2,000 associate / \$4,000 bachelor's). Credits transfer to Liberty University, subject to Liberty's normal transfer rules.

TRANSCRIPTS

- **You are the school**
You issue the transcript, and colleges accept parent-issued transcripts. Iowa sets no graduation requirements for homeschools; you define them (aim at the destination college's expectations).
- **Counting credits: 1 credit = about 1 year**
HSLDA standard: ~150 hours (academic) or ~120 (non-academic), a finished curriculum, or proven mastery (CLEP, dual enrollment). Fractions like 1/2 and 2/3 are normal.
- **Don't over-engineer it**
You can assemble the transcript in junior or senior year from casual notes. Keep notes somewhere as you go.
- **Real life counts**
Beekeeping, church tech booth, engine work: legitimate coursework once it's named. AI tools can help sort activities into courses, credits, and grades.
- **School profile**
A one-page companion document: philosophy, curricula, grading scale. Sample on the site.
- **Testing**
CLT (grades 3-8, CLT10, then CLT) works as a yearly benchmark; annual testing is not required in Iowa. SAT/ACT stay most widely accepted, and many merit scholarships want them.

NOTES



Paths, checklists, and links

THREE POSSIBLE PATHS

1. The CLEP Stacker

Modern States, then free CLEP exams, one subject at a time. Enter college with a bank of gen eds. Best for independent test-takers; can start as young as the student is ready.

2. The Dual-Enrollment Track

Real college courses in high school (FBBC or a community college). Start light, ramp up senior year; summer terms pack well. Builds a college GPA.

3. The Ministry / Budget Degree

Free CLI courses, low-fee degree, transfer to Liberty. Use CLEP to swap out gen eds under Liberty's transfer cap.

WORTH EXPLORING (not yet vetted)

GCU dual enrollment (\$52.50/credit) · Iowa Valley skilled trades (concurrent enrollment, Iowa) · DSST exams · Sophia & Saylor (ACE credit) · mikeroweWORKS trade scholarships · Agros (rural ministry) · degree-by-exam via Excelsior / TESU / Charter Oak.

BEFORE ANY EXAM OR ENROLLMENT: THE VERIFY CHECKLIST

- ☐ Search "[college name] CLEP equivalency" and read the college's own table.
- ☐ Read the academic catalog / student handbook: transfer rules and credit-by-exam caps live there.
- ☐ Email the registrar with your student's intended major and planned exams; keep the written reply.
- ☐ Ask admissions where the freshman-vs-transfer line sits (freshman scholarships are usually the biggest money).
- ☐ Ask financial aid what a full package could cover before paying for dual-enrollment credits.

LINKS WORTH TYPING

modernstates.org · free CLEP prep + exam vouchers

faith.edu · FBBC dual enrollment (\$150/credit)

educate.iowa.gov · Last-Dollar Scholarship details

hslida.org/legal/iowa · current Iowa homeschool law

clep.collegeboard.org · register for exams; credit policy search

christianleadersinstitute.org · free courses, low-cost degrees

cltexam.com · CLT tests and partner colleges

gcu.edu · GCU dual enrollment (\$52.50/credit)

AI PROMPT STARTERS (Claude, ChatGPT, or similar)

Activities into credits:

"Here is a list of my student's activities and projects with rough hours. Suggest course titles, credit amounts (about 120 hours = 1 credit), subject areas, and a short course description for each. Flag anything too thin to count."

School profile:

"Here is a description of our homeschool: philosophy, curricula, grading, and anything unusual. Draft a professional one-page school profile an admissions office would find clear and credible."

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